Mesiri

Field Guide · 00a · Companion to The big picture · Internal team edition

Roles

Everyone in and around a construction company, what their day looks like, what they want from software, what they will never do, and what they should be allowed to see. Software that ignores one of these people stops being used by them.

Draft, 8 Nov 2026. Built from industry practice, the customers we have met and construction software we studied. In a small company one person often holds several of these roles. Check with someone who has run sites.

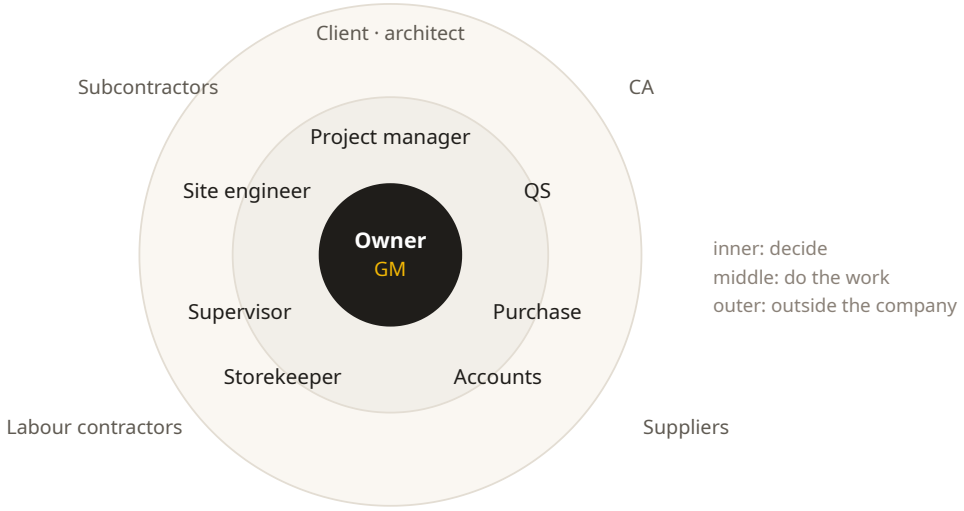
How to read this guide. Part 1 is the map of roles. Parts 2 to 5 give each role a card: who, where they work, what they ask, what they want, what they won't do, what makes them adopt or quit. Part 6 is who sees and does what. Part 7 is where roles pull against each other. Part 8 is what Mesiri has and what to build.

In this guide

1. The map of roles
2. Leadership: owner, GM
3. Project and site: PM, site engineer, supervisor, storekeeper, QS, MEP and quality
4. Office: purchase, accounts, the CA
5. Outside the company: subcontractor, labour contractor, supplier, client, architect
6. Who sees what, who does what
7. Where roles pull against each other
8. Mesiri today, and what to build
9. Check yourself

1 · THE MAP OF ROLES

Three circles: deciders, doers, and people outside



ROLE	WHERE THEY ARE	DEVICE	BEST CHANNEL	ONE-LINE WANT
Owner / MD	Office, travelling	Phone	WhatsApp summary; dashboard on demand	"Am I making money, and where am I losing it?"
GM	Office, site visits	Laptop and phone	Dashboard; WhatsApp alerts	"Did we get the work we paid for?"
Project manager	Sites and office	Phone, laptop	Both	"What needs me today on my projects?"
Site engineer	Site, all day	Phone	WhatsApp, voice	"Record it without stopping work."
Supervisor / foreman	Site, with workers	Basic phone	WhatsApp voice	"Tell me what to do; don't make me type."
Storekeeper	Site store, gate	Phone	WhatsApp, photo	"Prove what came and who took it."
QS	Office, site to measure	Laptop	Dashboard, Excel	"Quantities and rates I can trust."
MEP / quality engineer	Sites	Phone	WhatsApp; dashboard	"My trade's material and checks."
Purchase	Office, phone with shops	Laptop, phone	Dashboard; WhatsApp	"Buy right, once, on time."
Accounts	Office	Laptop	Dashboard, Excel, Tally	"Every bill matched, nothing paid twice."
CA (outside)	Their office	Laptop	Export to Tally	"Complete books, on time."

ROLE	WHERE THEY ARE	DEVICE	BEST CHANNEL	ONE-LINE WANT
Subcontractor	Site	Phone	WhatsApp	"Measure me fairly, pay me on time."
Labour contractor	Site	Basic phone	WhatsApp, voice	"My people's days and money, correct."
Supplier	Shop, depot	Phone	WhatsApp	"Clear orders; paid when due."
Client / house owner	Anywhere	Phone	WhatsApp, a link	"Is my building progressing, at my price?"
Architect / consultant	Their office	Laptop	A link, email	"Built to drawing; my approvals respected."

2 · LEADERSHIP

The people who pay for the software

Owner / MD

buys the software

THEIR DAY

Winning work, meeting clients and banks, cash, a few big decisions. Hears about sites by phone and in meetings.

TOP QUESTIONS

- Which projects make money, which lose it?
- How much cash do I need next month?
- Who owes me, whom do I owe?
- Is anything going badly wrong right now?

WANTS FROM SOFTWARE

- One screen or one message: profit per project, cash, risks.
- Problems pushed to him, not hunted for.
- Trust: numbers that match the accounts.
- Control: who can see rates and margins.

WON'T DO

Enter data. Learn a complex system. Read long reports.

ADOPTS WHEN · QUITS WHEN

It catches one real loss early · its numbers disagree with Tally or the GM.

General manager (GM)

often decides on the purchase

THEIR DAY

Runs all projects; releases payments to suppliers, subcontractors and labour; settles problems between sites and office.

TOP QUESTIONS

- "Was ₹15,000 of work done for the ₹15,000 we paid?"
- Which site is behind or over budget?
- What is short, and has it been ordered?
- What needs my approval?

WANTS FROM SOFTWARE

- Daily green/red by project and work item.
- Approvals in one place, with the facts beside them.
- Material: what came, what was used, what is missing.
- Every number traceable to who reported it.

WON'T DO

Accept a digital register as the answer ("noting down that cement arrived has no benefit").

ADOPTS WHEN · QUITS WHEN

It answers his payment questions the same day · engineers stop reporting and the screens go stale.

The people who create the data

Project manager (PM)

THEIR DAY

Moves between 2 to 5 sites; plans the week; chases material, labour and subcontractors; reports to the GM.

TOP QUESTIONS

- What is planned this week, and is everything in place?
- Which site hasn't reported?
- Is anything about to run out? Can another site lend it?

WANTS FROM SOFTWARE

- A morning list of what needs him, across his projects only.
- Approve requests and small expenses from the phone.
- Move stock between his sites.
- Progress against plan, not a diary.

WON'T DO

Re-type what engineers already sent.

ADOPTS WHEN · QUITS WHEN

It saves his phone calls · he still has to call to find out.

Site engineer

the most important user

THEIR DAY

On site from morning: sets out work, checks quality, measures, handles deliveries and labour, answers calls. Evenings: the daily report.

TOP QUESTIONS

- Do I have what tomorrow's work needs?
- How do I report today without an hour of typing?
- Who did I ask for cement, and when is it coming?

WANTS FROM SOFTWARE

- Report by voice or one line, in Malayalam or Manglish.
- Confirm, don't fill forms.
- Fewer phone calls from the office.
- Credit for good work (the report shows it).

WON'T DO

Install another app, log in, fill fields, report the same thing twice.

ADOPTS WHEN · QUITS WHEN

Reporting takes less time than before · it asks too many questions or feels like surveillance.

If the site engineer stops sending, every other role's screen goes empty. Design for this person first.

Supervisor / foreman

THEIR DAY

With the workers all day: who does what, where, with which material. Often limited reading or typing; speaks the local language.

TOP QUESTIONS

- What is today's work for my team?
- Is the material there?

WANTS FROM SOFTWARE

- Voice in, voice or short text out.
- Attendance in one message ("4 mason 2 helper").

WON'T DO

Read English screens, type, use a dashboard.

Storekeeper

THEIR DAY

At the gate and the store: receives lorries, counts, stores, issues material to teams, keeps the register.

TOP QUESTIONS

- Does the lorry match the challan and the order?
- Who took what, for which work?

WANTS FROM SOFTWARE

- Photo of the challan plus one line, and it is recorded.
- The open order to check the lorry against.
- Proof, so he isn't blamed for shortages.

WON'T DO

Fill a GRN form per lorry; keep two registers (paper and app).

Quantity surveyor (QS)

THEIR DAY

Measures work, prepares client and subcontractor bills, checks material and cost against the estimate.

TOP QUESTIONS

- How much of each BOQ item is done?
- Does material used match the work done?
- Is this subcontractor's bill right?

WANTS FROM SOFTWARE

- BOQ with quantities done to date, by item.
- Material reconciliation and wastage %.
- Export to Excel; bills from measured quantities.

WON'T DO

Trust numbers he can't trace or adjust with a reason.

MEP engineer · quality and safety engineer

in larger companies

Own one trade (electrical and plumbing) or one discipline (quality, safety) across sites. **Want:** their category's material and requests, their checklists, alerts only for their area. **Won't:** wade through everything else.

4 · OFFICE

The people who turn site activity into money

Purchase

THEIR DAY

Phones shops for rates, places orders, chases deliveries, handles returns. In small companies the owner or PM does this.

TOP QUESTIONS

- What do sites need, by when?
- Did someone already order it?
- What did we pay last time, and where?

WANTS FROM SOFTWARE

- All requests in one list, with needed-by dates.
- Rate history per item and supplier.
- Orders with what is still pending; duplicate warnings.

WON'T DO

Chase engineers on the phone for what they need.

Accounts

THEIR DAY

Matches bills to deliveries, pays suppliers, labour and subcontractors, collects from clients, keeps petty cash, hands books to the CA.

TOP QUESTIONS

- Which bills are due, and are they correct?
- Where is the bill for this delivery?
- What do we owe each party; what do clients owe us?

WANTS FROM SOFTWARE

- Delivered-not-billed list; bill matched to order and delivery.
- Party ledgers and payables by due date.
- Expenses with photos and categories.
- Export to Tally, without retyping.

WON'T DO

Keep a second set of books; accept entries without a trail.

CA (chartered accountant, outside)

Keeps the statutory books in Tally, files GST and TDS, runs the audit. **Wants:** complete, correctly coded entries on time, as a Tally import or Excel. **Won't:** log into another system daily. **Why it matters:** if the CA distrusts the numbers, the owner will too.

5 · OUTSIDE THE COMPANY

People the company works with, who can feed or check the system

ROLE	WANTS	COULD DO IN SOFTWARE	SHOULD NEVER SEE
Subcontractor	Fair measurement, prompt payment, clear work orders.	See their work order, measured quantities and bills; send progress by WhatsApp.	Other subcontractors' rates; the company's margins.

ROLE	WANTS	COULD DO IN SOFTWARE	SHOULD NEVER SEE
Labour contractor	Correct days and wages; advances recorded.	Confirm attendance and weekly totals by WhatsApp.	Anything but their own people and money.
Supplier	Clear orders, prompt payment.	Receive orders, send bills, see their balance.	Other suppliers' rates.
Client / house owner	Progress, photos, bills they can understand.	A link with progress and photos; RA bills; approve variations.	Costs, margins, supplier rates, internal issues.
Architect / consultant	Built to drawing; their approvals respected.	See progress and quality checks; answer questions.	Money.

6 · WHO SEES WHAT, WHO DOES WHAT

A starting point for permissions

✓ yes · **own** only their projects or sites · **—** no. A proposal from common practice; each company adjusts it.

WHAT	OWNER / GM	PM	SITE ENG.	STORE	QS	PURCHASE	ACCOUNTS	CLIENT
See								
Work done, photos, issues	✓	own	own	own	✓	—	—	own
Stock and deliveries	✓	own	own	own	✓	✓	✓	—
Purchase rates	✓	own	—	—	✓	✓	✓	—
Client rates and margins	✓	own	—	—	✓	—	✓	—
Wages	✓	own	own team	—	✓	—	✓	—
Supplier and party balances	✓	—	—	—	—	✓	✓	—
Their own green / red	✓	own	own site	—	✓	—	—	—
Do								
Record work, labour, material	✓	✓	✓	material	—	—	—	—
Request material	✓	✓	✓	✓	—	—	—	—
Approve requests and expenses	✓	up to a limit	—	—	—	—	—	—
Place orders	✓	✓	—	—	—	✓	—	—
Correct or adjust stock	✓	✓	—	with reason	—	—	—	—
Set BOQ and budget	✓	✓	—	—	✓	—	—	—
Pay and record payments	✓	—	—	—	—	—	✓	—
Approve variations	✓	—	—	—	—	—	—	✓
Set up company, people, categories	✓	some	—	—	—	—	—	—

Two rules that never change: **the person who orders is not the one who receives, and neither is the one who pays**; and **outsiders only ever see their own records**.

7 · WHERE ROLES PULL AGAINST EACH OTHER

Good software settles these, instead of picking a side

THE PULL	HOW TO SETTLE IT
Owner wants detail; engineer wants to type less.	Capture the minimum by voice; fill the rest from what already exists (orders, BOQ, last rate); ask at most one question.
GM wants control; site wants speed.	Approvals with limits: small things go straight through, big ones wait, and the approver sees the facts in the same message.

THE PULL	HOW TO SETTLE IT
Accounts wants every field; the gate knows only item and quantity.	Record now, complete later: the bill photo fills rate and supplier afterwards.
Owner wants to watch; engineers fear being watched.	Show engineers their own green/red and credit for good days, not only mistakes.
Client wants transparency; company protects margins.	Separate views: the client sees progress and bills, never cost.
Purchase wants the best rate; site wants it today.	Requests with needed-by dates, so urgency is visible and planned.

8 · MESIRI TODAY, AND WHAT TO BUILD

Four roles today; the rest arrive on WhatsApp

ROLE	MESIRI	HOW IT IS SERVED TODAY · WHAT IS MISSING
Owner / MD	Partly	As Admin / Director: everything, plus the evening DPR. Missing: a one-screen owner view (profit per project, cash, risks) and a weekly owner message.
GM	Partly	As Admin. Missing: green/red (CC-07), approvals in one place, payment checks against work.
Project manager	Have	A role with its own projects and sites; requests, transfers, sizes. Missing: a morning "needs you" list.
Site engineer	Have	A role, mainly on WhatsApp in Malayalam, Manglish or English; sees only their sites; doesn't see company spending.
Supervisor / foreman	Partly	Can be added as a site engineer and use WhatsApp voice. Missing: a lighter role that only reports, without dashboard access.
Storekeeper	Partly	Same as above. Missing: a store role (record material, adjust with reason) and GRN against orders.
QS	Missing	No role; today a PM or admin. Missing: BOQ progress, reconciliation, measured bills.
MEP / quality / safety	Missing	No owner per category or checklist.
Purchase	Missing	No role; procurement pages are planned (PRC-06 onwards).
Accounts	Have	The Finance role: expenses, money, vendors. Missing: payables, party ledgers, Tally sync.
CA	Missing	No access; planned Tally export.
Subcontractor, labour contractor	Missing	Appear only as names on records. Missing: their own WhatsApp view of work orders, measurements and payments.
Supplier	Partly	A vendor record with phone and GSTIN. Missing: orders and balance sent to them.
Client / house owner	Partly	Can receive the DPR as an outside contact, with the client's logo. Missing: a progress link, RA bills, variation approval.

What to build, in order.

1. **Decide who sees rates and margins** (decision D-CC4 in the cost-control plan), using part 6 as the starting point. Security-sensitive: needs approval.
2. **A reporting-only role** for supervisors and storekeepers: WhatsApp only, their site only, no dashboard.
3. **A role home for each person:** owner (profit, cash, risks), GM (green/red, approvals), PM (needs you today), accounts (due bills, unbilled deliveries).
4. **QS and Purchase roles** when the BOQ-progress and procurement pages exist.
5. **Outside views on WhatsApp:** client progress link first (easy and impressive), then subcontractor statements.

Where this lives in the code: role names in `backend/src/mesiri/domains/users/router.py` (`_VALID_ROLES`); who may do what in `backend/src/mesiri/authorization/roles.py` ; the dashboard's labels and scopes in `apps/dashboard/src/lib/permissions.ts` .

9 · CHECK YOURSELF

1. Which role, if it stops using the software, empties everyone else's screens?
2. What does the GM want that a digital register can't give him?
3. Name the three hands that must be separate in buying.
4. What should a client never see, and what should they see?
5. Which two roles would most benefit from a reporting-only WhatsApp role?

Answers: 1. The site engineer. 2. Whether the work done matched the money paid: green or red, the same day. 3. Who orders, who receives, who pays. 4. Never cost, margins or supplier rates; they see progress, photos and their bills. 5. Supervisor/foreman and storekeeper.